

16과 배가 아파서 병원에 가요

Chapter 16 — My stomach hurts, so I'm going to the doctor

This chapter at a glance

주제	Topic 병원 — the doctor's
어휘와 문법	Vocabulary & grammar 병원 어휘 / 동형-어서 / 동-는 것 — words for the body and the clinic · giving a reason · turning a verb into a noun
활동	Activities 아픈 친구에게 조언하기, 아픈 이유 말하기 — advising a friend who is unwell; saying what is wrong
문화와 정보	Culture & information 한국의 병원 — how hospitals work in Korea

This is the chapter you will actually need. Somebody will ask 어디가 아파요? and you will have to answer, and the vocabulary here — the parts of the body, the names of the clinics — is the difference between being treated and being guessed at.

The two grammar points are the two halves of that conversation. -어서 says why (배가 아파서), and -는 것 is how Korean gives advice without ordering anyone about (병원에 가는 것이 좋아요). One explains, the other suggests.

도입

Warm-up

이 사람들은 어디가 아파요?

What is wrong with these people?

여러분은 어느 병원에 가 봤어요?

Which kind of clinic have you been to?

Three scenes, three kinds of clinic. A doctor at her desk explaining something to a man who has a hand on his stomach — internal medicine. A dentist working on a patient tilted back in the chair. And a paediatric waiting room: a mother with her hand on a small girl's forehead, another child in a mask, a receptionist behind the counter.

어디가 아파요? is literally "where hurts?", and it is the first thing a doctor, a pharmacist or a concerned colleague will say to you. Learn it as a fixed phrase — you will hear it far more often than you say it.

가 봤어요? is 가다 plus -어 보다, "to try doing", plus the past tense: have you ever been? You will meet the form properly later; for now read 가 봤어요? as "have you been?" and answer 네, 가 봤어요 or 아니요, 안 가 봤어요.

어휘와 문법 1

Vocabulary & grammar 1

어디가 아파요? 어느 병원에 가요?

Where does it hurt? Which clinic do you go to?

몸 — the body

눈

eye

이

tooth

허리

lower back, waist

다리

leg

귀

ear

목

neck, throat

손

hand

무릎

knee

코

nose

팔

arm

배

stomach, belly

발

foot

목 is both the neck and the throat, and Korean does not separate them. 목이 아파요 is what you say for a sore throat — which is how it is used all through this chapter — but the same phrase would serve for a stiff neck. Context decides.

배 is the belly, the whole abdomen, not the organ. So 배가 아파요 covers indigestion, cramps, period pain and food poisoning alike. It is also a homograph with 배 (pear) and 배 (boat), and all three turn up in this book.

허리 is the lower back and the waist together. Koreans say 허리가 아파요 for back pain far more often than they name any other part of the spine, and it is the complaint that most often sends someone to 정형외과.

Watch out for 이 — the tooth. It is spelled exactly like the subject marker 이 and like 이 (this), so 이가 아파요 has two 이 in a row doing different jobs. In careful speech people often say 치아 instead to avoid the clash.

병원 — kinds of clinic

내과

internal medicine — colds, stomach, general illness

정형외과

orthopaedics — bones, joints, back

치과

dentistry — teeth

이비인후과

ear, nose and throat

안과

ophthalmology — eyes

These names decode, and once you see how, you never have to memorise them again. 안 is eye, 치 is tooth, 과 is department. 내과 is the "inside" department, 외과 the "outside" one, so 정형외과 is orthopaedic surgery. And 이비인후과 is 이 ear + 비 nose + 인후 throat — the same ear-nose-throat that names the specialism everywhere.

In everyday Korean 병원 means any doctor's, including a single room above a shop. The legal distinction is by size — 의원 has under thirty beds, 병원 thirty or more — but nobody says 의원에 가요 in conversation. Say 병원에 가요 and then name the department.

여러분 친구가 아파요. 어느 병원에 가요? 이야기해 보세요.

A friend of yours is unwell. Which clinic should they go to? Talk about it.

가 이가 아파요.

My tooth hurts.

나 그럼, 빨리 치과에 가세요.

Then go to the dentist, quickly.

Korean says the body part hurts, not that you hurt, and marks the part with 이/가: 이가 아파요, 배가 아파요, 눈이 아파요. The person drops out of the sentence altogether. You met this already in chapter 9 with 다리가 아팠습니다.

아프다 does the work of a whole set of words — to hurt, to ache, to be sore, to be ill, to be in pain. There is no separate verb for a headache versus a broken arm versus the flu. Name the part, add 아파요, and you have said it.

동형-어서

Verb/adjective + -어서

앞의 내용이 뒤의 내용의 이유가 될 때 사용해요.

Used when what comes before it is the reason for what comes after.

- 가** 어제 왜 병원에 갔어요?
Why did you go to the doctor yesterday?
- 나** 배가 아파서 병원에 갔어요.
My stomach hurt, so I went to the doctor.

예문 — examples

- 가** 그 드라마를 자주 봐요?
Do you watch that drama often?
- 나** 네, 재미있어서 자주 봐요.
Yes — it's good, so I watch it often.

어제는 피곤해서 집에서 쉬었어요.
Yesterday I was tired, so I rested at home.

-아서 · -어서 · -해서

-아서 · 높다 → 높아서
when the stem vowel is ㅏ or ㅑ

-어서 · 먹다 → 먹어서
after any other vowel

-해서 · 피곤하다 → 피곤해서
하다 verbs → because I'm tired

★ **아프다 → 아파서**
to hurt → because it hurts

감기에 걸리다 → 감기에 걸려서
to catch a cold → because I caught a cold

청소하다 → 청소해서
to clean → because I cleaned

The 아/어/해 choice is exactly the one you already make for the present tense and the past. If you can produce 만나요 / 먹어요 / 해요 and 만났어요 / 먹었어요 / 했어요, you can produce 만나서 / 먹어서 / 해서 without learning anything new. It is the same fork, a third time.

The starred 아프다 → 아파서 is the —irregular. A stem ending in — drops that vowel before an ending that starts with a vowel, and the vowel before it decides which ending you get. 아프다 has ㅏ, so 아파서. Compare 바쁘다 → 바빠서 and 예쁘다 → 예뻐서 — same rule, different outcome, because the preceding vowel differs.

The one rule that catches everyone: -어서 never takes a tense marker. It is 어제는 피곤해서 집에서 쉬었어요, never 피곤했어서. The past sits on the final verb only, and the reason clause stays plain. Korean reads the tense off the end of the sentence and applies it backwards.

The second restriction matters just as much: you cannot follow -어서 with a command or a suggestion. 배가 아파서 병원에 가세요 is wrong, and so is 배가 아파서 병원에 갈까요? -어서 states a fact and then its consequence; it cannot lead into telling someone what to do. That gap is precisely why the next page exists.

감기에 걸리다 is the fixed way to say you have caught a cold — with 예, and with 걸리다, which elsewhere means to be caught or to take time. Never 감기를 가지다. Learn it whole: 감기에 걸렸어요, I've got a cold.

1 어느 병원에 가요? 왜 가요? 이야기해 보세요.

1 Which clinic are you going to? Why? Talk about it.

보기 눈이 아프다 · 안과 → 눈이 아파서 안과에 가요.

Model: eyes hurt · ophthalmology → My eyes hurt, so I'm going to the eye clinic.

1) 감기에 걸리다 · 내과

to catch a cold · internal medicine

2) 이가 아프다 · 치과

tooth hurts · the dentist

3) 다리가 부러지다 · 정형외과

to break a leg · orthopaedics

부러지다 is intransitive — the leg breaks, by itself. You do not say who broke it. 다리가 부러졌어요 is how you report a fracture, with 이/가 on the leg just like 아프다. The transitive partner is 부러뜨리다, to snap something, and you will need it far less often.

2 여러분은 왜 병원에 갔어요? 친구와 이야기해 보세요.

2 Why did you go to the doctor? Talk about it with a classmate.

어휘와 문법 2

Vocabulary & grammar 2

감기에 걸렸어요. 어떻게 해요?

You've caught a cold. What do you do?

감기에 걸리다 — what to do about it

물을 많이 마시다

to drink plenty of water

생강차를 마시다

to drink ginger tea

비타민 시(C)를 먹다

to take vitamin C

꼭 쉬다

to rest properly, to get a good rest

약을 먹다

to take medicine

병원에 가다

to go to the doctor

생강차 is the standard Korean home remedy for a sore throat — ginger sliced thin and preserved in honey or sugar, then spooned into hot water. Jars of it sit in most kitchens through the winter, and offering it is a small act of care, which is exactly what it is doing in this chapter's dialogue.

Korean says 약을 먹다 — to eat medicine. Tablets, capsules, powders and syrups all take 먹다. There is no separate verb for taking medicine, and 약을 마시다 would sound odd even for a liquid.

꼭 is an adverb meaning thoroughly, deeply, all the way. It attaches to rest and sleep in particular: 꼭 쉬다, 꼭 자다. 꼭 쉬세요 is what a Korean colleague says as you leave the office ill, and it is warmer than a bare 쉬세요.

비타민 시(C) shows how Korean handles a Latin letter in the middle of a word: it is spelled out as its Korean syllable name, 시. The same happens with 에이(A), 비타민 디(D), and with sizes — 에스, 엠, 엘.

여러분이 감기에 걸렸어요. 어떻게 해요? 이야기해 보세요.

You've caught a cold. What do you do? Talk about it.

저는 감기에 걸려서 약을 먹었어요.

I caught a cold, so I took some medicine.

This is the sentence the whole page has been building to: the reason from the previous page, plus the vocabulary from this one. 감기에 걸려서 — with the | of 걸리 contracting to 려 — then whatever you did about it.

동-는 것

Verb + -는 것

동사를 주어나 목적어 등으로 사용하기 위해서 명사로 만들 때 사용해요.

Used to turn a verb into a noun so it can serve as a subject, an object and so on.

안젤라 선생님, 오늘 배가 아파서 학교에 못 가요. 약을 먹었지만 계속 아파요.

Teacher, my stomach hurts today so I can't come to class. I took medicine but it still hurts.

선생님 그래요? 그러면 빨리 병원에 가는 것이 좋아요.

Really? Then you'd better get to a doctor quickly.

예문 — examples

가 잠시드 씨, 노래방에 안 가요?

Jamshid, aren't you coming to the noraebang?

나 네, 저는 노래 부르는 것을 안 좋아해요.

No — I don't like singing.

잘 먹는 것이 건강에 좋아요.

Eating well is good for your health.

-는 것

먹다 → 먹는 것

to eat → eating

씻다 → 씻는 것

to wash → washing

가다 → 가는 것

to go → going

쉬다 → 쉬는 것

to rest → resting

-는 것 turns a verb into a thing, so that the rest of the sentence can do something with it. Once a verb is wearing 것 it behaves like any noun: it takes 이/가 to be the subject (먹는 것이 좋아요), 을/를 to be the object (부르는 것을 좋아해요), and any other particle you already know.

It attaches straight to the stem with no 으, whatever the stem ends in — 먹는 것, 가는 것 alike. But a stem ending in ㄹ drops it: 살다 → 사는 것, 만들다 → 만드는 것. That is the same disappearance you met last chapter in 살다 → 사네요, and for the same reason — ㄹ falls before ㄴ.

-는 것 is for action verbs only. Descriptive verbs take -은 것 instead (좋은 것, 예쁜 것), which is why this section is headed 동 and not 동형. You are not asked to produce that form yet, but it explains the label.

In speech 것 contracts against the particle that follows: 것이 → 게, 것을 → 겔, 것은 → 건. So 쉬는 것이 좋아요 comes out as 쉬는 게 좋아요, and that is what you will actually hear. Write it long, say it short.

-는 것이 좋아요 is how Korean gives advice. Literally "doing X is good" — it recommends the action rather than instructing the person, so it lands far more gently than 가세요. Remember that -어서 cannot be followed by a command; this is the construction that fills the gap. 배가 아파서 병원에 가는 것이 좋아요 works, where the imperative version does not.

The dialogue quietly reuses three chapters at once: 못 가요 is the 못 of chapter 14, 먹었지만 is the -지만 of chapter 11, and 아파서 is this chapter's new ending. A single sick-note text message, built from a term's worth of grammar.

1 감기에 걸렸어요. 어떻게 하는 것이 좋아요? 이야기해 보세요.

1 You've caught a cold. What is the best thing to do? Talk about it.

보기 집에서 쉬다 → 집에서 푹 쉬는 것이 좋아요.

Model: rest at home → It's best to have a proper rest at home.

1) 병원에 가다

to go to the doctor

2) 생강차를 마시다

to drink ginger tea

3) 약을 먹다

to take medicine

2 건강이 안 좋아요. 어떻게 하는 것이 좋아요? 이야기해 보세요.

2 Your health isn't good. What is the best thing to do? Talk about it.

건강이 안 좋다 is the ordinary way to say someone is in poor health, and it is gentler than 아프다 — a state rather than a symptom. The positive is 건강이 좋다, and 건강하다 on its own means to be healthy, which is what you wish people at New Year: 건강하세요.

말하기와 듣기

Speaking & listening

1 라민 씨와 안젤라 씨가 이야기해요. 다음과 같이 이야기해 보세요.

1 Ramin and Angela are talking. Practise the conversation below.

라민 안젤라 씨, 얼굴이 안 좋네요. 어디 아파요?

Angela, you don't look well. Is something wrong?

안젤라 네, 목이 너무 아파서 잠을 못 잤어요.

Yes — my throat hurts so much I couldn't sleep.

라민 그러면 생강차를 마시는 것이 좋아요.

Then you should drink some ginger tea.

안젤라 네, 고마워요.

Thanks.

이렇게 바꿔서 연습해 보세요 — practise with these substitutions

1) 목이 너무 아프다, 잠을 못 자다 | 생강차를 마시다

throat hurts badly, couldn't sleep | drink ginger tea

2) 배가 너무 아프다, 밥을 못 먹다 | 병원에 가다

stomach hurts badly, couldn't eat | go to the doctor

얼굴이 안 좋네요 — literally "your face isn't good" — is the normal way to tell someone they look unwell, and it is meant kindly. Note that it uses the -네요 you learned last chapter: he has just noticed, and he is saying so.

어디 아파요? here, not 어디가 아파요?. Dropping the 가 makes it vaguer and softer — closer to "are you not feeling well?" than "which part hurts?". A doctor asks with the 가; a friend often asks without it.

잠을 못 자다 pairs the noun 잠 with its own verb 자다 — literally "to sleep sleep". Korean does this often (꿈을 꾸다, to dream a dream; 춤을 추다, to dance a dance), and the pairs have to be learned together.

This exchange is the chapter working exactly as designed: notice with -네요, ask, explain with -어서, advise with -는 것이 좋아요. Four lines, and you have looked after someone in Korean.

2 어디가 아플 때, 어떻게 하는 것이 좋아요? 이야기해 보세요.

2 When something hurts, what is the best thing to do? Talk about it.

-을 때 means "when", and it is coming in a later chapter. For now read 아플 때 as "when it hurts" and use it as a fixed phrase in this exercise.

듣기 — 이링 씨가 약국에서 이야기해요. 잘 듣고 답해 보세요.

1) 이링 씨는 왜 약국에 갔어요?

Why did Yiling go to the pharmacy?

2) 약사는 이링 씨에게 어떻게 하라고 말했어요?

What did the pharmacist tell her to do?

약국 is the pharmacy and 약사 is the pharmacist. In Korea the pharmacy is a genuine first stop: pharmacists will listen to your symptoms and hand you something over the counter without a prescription, and for a mild cold most people go there before they go to 내과.

읽기와 쓰기

Reading & writing

1 다음 글을 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

1 Read the passage and answer the questions.

안젤라 씨는 요즘 날씨가 추워서 감기에 걸렸어요.

The weather has been cold lately, so Angela has caught a cold.

목이 많이 아파서 생강차를 마셨어요.

Her throat hurt a lot, so she drank ginger tea.

그렇지만 계속 아파서 이비인후과에 갔어요.

But it kept hurting, so she went to an ear, nose and throat clinic.

의사 선생님께서는 "약을 먹고 집에서 꼭 쉬는 것이 좋아요. 그리고 물을 많이 마시는 것이 좋아요."라고 말했어요.

The doctor said, "You should take this medicine and get a proper rest at home. And you should drink plenty of water."

그래서 오늘 안젤라 씨는 친구를 만나지 않고 집에서 쉴 거예요.

So today Angela is not going to meet her friend; she'll rest at home instead.

Count the -어서 in this passage: 추워서, 아파서, 아파서. Three reasons in five sentences, each one causing the next. That chain — cold weather, so a cold; a sore throat, so ginger tea; still sore, so the clinic — is the shape the whole chapter has been teaching.

께서는 is the honorific version of 은/는, used because the subject is 의사 선생님. It is the 높임말 from chapter 12 applied to the topic marker. Note that the verb stays plain 말했어요 — the passage honours the doctor through the particle rather than throughout, which is normal in written Korean.

만나지 않고 is the long negative -지 않다 joined with -고: not meeting, and instead. The short form 안 만나고 means the same thing and is commoner in speech; the long form is preferred in writing and when the verb is long.

-라고 말했어요 reports someone's exact words, and the quotation marks in the passage are doing the same job. You will learn reported speech properly later; for now, notice that the quoted sentence keeps its own polite ending 좋아요 unchanged inside the quotation.

1) 안젤라 씨는 어디가 아파서 병원에 갔어요?

1) What was hurting that sent Angela to the doctor?

→ 목이 아파서 갔어요.

→ Her throat hurt.

2) 맞으면 ○, 틀리면 X 하세요.

2) Mark ○ if true, X if false.

① 이비인후과에 갔어요.

She went to an ENT clinic — ○

② 물을 조금만 마시는 것이 좋아요.

It's best to drink only a little water — , the doctor said plenty

③ 안젤라 씨는 오늘 친구를 만날 거예요.

Angela is going to meet her friend today — , she is staying home

Item ② turns on one word: 조금만, only a little, against the passage's 많이. Both sentences are otherwise identical, so the exercise is testing whether you read the quantity or skimmed past it.

3) 안젤라 씨는 오늘 뭐 할 거예요?

3) What is Angela going to do today?

→ 집에서 쉴 거예요.

→ She's going to rest at home.

쉴 거예요 is the -을 거예요 future from chapter 12, and 쉬다 has a vowel stem, so it takes -을 with no 으: 쉴 거예요. The passage uses it twice, which is a good reminder that the future turns up constantly once you have it.

2 이 사람들은 무엇을 왜 못 해요? 어떻게 하는 것이 좋아요? 써 보세요.

2 What can these people not do, and why? What would be best? Write it out.

1) 라흐만 씨는 팔이 아파서 일을 못 합니다. 그래서 정형외과에 가는 것이 좋습니다.

1) Rahman's arm hurts, so he can't work. He had better go to an orthopaedic clinic.

2) 라민 씨는 ____

Ramin is in bed looking feverish and unwell

3) 후엔 씨는 ____

Huyen has a hand pressed to her cheek, in pain

4) 성민이는 ____

Seongmin has a hand cupped over his ear

The worked example gives you the exact frame to copy: 「name + 은/는 + body part + 이/가 아파서 + what they can't do + 못 합니다. 그래서 + clinic + 에 가는 것이 좋습니다.」 Both halves of the chapter in two sentences, in the formal -습니다 style.

From the pictures, the natural answers are a fever or general illness for Ramin (내과), toothache for Huyen (치과), and earache for Seongmin (이비인후과). Those are suggestions, not printed answers — the book leaves the lines blank on purpose, and your own wording is the point of the exercise.

성민이는 rather than 성민 씨는: adding 이 to a name ending in a consonant is what Korean does with children and close juniors, and it signals that Seongmin is a boy rather than an adult classmate. The other three all get 씨.

문화와 정보 — 한국의 병원

Culture & information — hospitals in Korea

한국의 병원은 세 가지 종류가 있습니다.

There are three tiers of hospital in Korea.

의원과 보건소는 1차 병원입니다.

Clinics and public health centres are primary care.

병원과 종합 병원은 2차 병원입니다.

Hospitals and general hospitals are secondary care.

상급 종합 병원은 3차 병원입니다.

Tertiary referral hospitals are the third tier.

먼저 1차, 2차 병원에 갑니다. 의사에게 진료를 받습니다.

You go to a primary or secondary hospital first, and are seen by a doctor there.

진료가 더 필요할 경우, 진료 의뢰서를 받고 3차 병원에 갑니다.

If further treatment is needed, you get a referral letter and go to a tertiary hospital.

This is not merely administrative. Without a 진료 의뢰서, national health insurance will not cover your visit to a tertiary hospital, and you will be billed the full amount. Turning up at a big university hospital with an ordinary complaint is the most expensive mistake a new resident can make.

보건소 is the public health centre run by your district office, and it is worth knowing about specifically as a newcomer. Vaccinations, health screenings, tuberculosis checks and basic consultations are free or very cheap there, and many services are aimed at foreign residents.

종합 병원 is a general hospital — 종합 means comprehensive, so it has most departments under one roof. 상급 종합 병원 adds 상급, higher grade: the large university hospitals that handle serious and rare conditions, and that the referral system is designed to protect.

질문 — questions

1) 병원의 종류에는 무엇이 있어요?

What kinds of hospital are there? → 1차, 2차, 3차 병원이 있어요

2) 가장 먼저 어느 병원에 가요?

Which do you go to first? → 1차, 2차 병원에 가요

3) 여러분 고향의 병원을 소개해 보세요.

Tell the class how hospitals work back home.

1. 병원의 종류를 알아보세요 — the three tiers

1차 병원 · 의원, 보건소

primary — local clinics and public health centres

3차 병원 · 상급 종합 병원

tertiary — major referral hospitals

2차 병원 · 병원, 종합 병원

secondary — hospitals and general hospitals

2. 병원 방문 순서를 알아보세요 — the order of a visit

1차, 2차 병원 진료

be seen at a primary or secondary hospital

진료 의뢰서 받기

get a referral letter

3차 병원 예약

book an appointment at a tertiary hospital

3차 병원 진료

be treated at the tertiary hospital

진료 is medical treatment or consultation, and it combines endlessly: 진료실 consulting room, 진료비 the fee, 진료 시간 opening hours. 의뢰 is a referral or request, so 진료 의뢰서 is literally a treatment-request document.

차 here counts tiers or rounds, not vehicles — 1차, 2차, 3차. The same word orders anything sequential, which is why a first round of drinks is 1차 and moving on to the second bar is 2차. Same counter, very different evening.

발음 · 배운 어휘 확인

Pronunciation · vocabulary check

발음 1 — 다음을 듣고 따라 읽으세요.

내과 [내과]

nae-kkwa

치과 [치과]

chi-kkwa

안과 [안과]

an-kkwa

The 과 in a department name is pronounced tense, [과], and the spelling never shows it. This is the tensing that happens inside many Sino-Korean compounds, and it applies right across the set — 이비인후과 and 정형외과 end the same way. Say 내과 with a plain 과 and you will be understood, but you will not sound like you have been to one.

A useful contrast: 과 as a standalone word — the 과 of 사과, apple, or the 와/과 particle — stays plain. It is only inside these compounds that it tenses. Learn the clinic names with the tense sound baked in and the problem disappears.

발음 2 — 다음을 듣고 연습해 보세요.

가 어제 왜 병원에 갔어요?

Why did you go to the doctor yesterday?

나 배가 아파서 내과에 갔어요

My stomach hurt, so I went to internal medicine.

가 이가 아파요.

My tooth hurts.

나 그럼 빨리 치과에 가세요.

Then get to a dentist quickly.

가 근처에 안과가 있어요?

Is there an eye clinic nearby?

나 저 아파트 맞은편에 있어요.

There's one opposite that apartment block.

맞은편 is the opposite side, the far side of a road or a room. It is built on 맞다, to face or match, and it joins 앞, 뒤, 옆 and 근처 in the set of position words you need to give or follow directions.

배운 어휘 확인 — vocabulary check

눈

eye

코

nose

이

tooth

귀

ear

목

neck, throat

팔

arm

허리

lower back, waist

배

stomach, belly

손

hand

다리

leg

무릎

knee

발

foot

내과

internal medicine

이비인후과

ear, nose and throat

정형외과

orthopaedics

안과

ophthalmology

치과

dentistry

다리가 부러지다

to break a leg

생강차

ginger tea

비타민 시(C)

vitamin C

꼭 쉬다

to rest properly